

The Foundation of the Love of God

Open to 1 Corinthians 12. I do believe that by faith we are even going to make it there.

Hallelujah.

This week we are going to talk about revival. Do you want to talk about revival? If you can yell like that when we are done, then we have succeeded. Of course, you may just be sitting there looking at me too, because you do not know yet. You have not heard what we are going to say.

Would you please extend your faith and agree with me? I feel the Holy Spirit slipping up on me. Glory to God. Things have been different. I feel Him slipping up on me, so enter into agreement. I feel the Teacher. I feel the Exhorter. I also feel the Miracle Worker. Glory. Somehow He is going to get all three of them in here this morning. Hallelujah.

Please agree with me.

Heavenly Father, once again, as we enter into Your presence, we do it with boldness, full of Your grace and full of Your power. As Your blood-bought righteous children, purchased unto right standing, we approach You with boldness. We thank You that because of the person of the Holy Spirit, we do not have to take creeds and doctrines originating with men, but again we have pure, undefiled access to the very best You have.

As Your children, we refuse to settle for anything less than Your best. More than anything else, Father, we humble ourselves. We humble ourselves and prostrate ourselves in Your presence. We ask You, Father, teach us by Your Holy Spirit. Teach us how to enter more boldly into Your presence.

As Your children, for all the miracles You are about to manifest, we thank You and praise You. But more than these, for the understanding of Your Word. Oh Father, Your Word, the understanding of Your Word, not only sets us free but supplies all the power we need to walk that way as Your children.

We give You praise, honor, and glory. Amen. Amen.

Hallelujah. Thank You, Jesus.

If you had asked me three years ago, "Brother Roberson, are you walking in peace?" I would have said, "Does a dog have fleas in Oklahoma? Can a fish swim? What else would I say? I am a faith man."

"Are you walking in peace?"

"Most certainly."

That is because I did not have now to compare with then.

My prayer is that two or three years from now, you can ask me, "Brother Roberson, were you walking in peace three years ago?" making reference to this time, and the change will be so profound that I will not have then to compare with now, because He has done something that has so changed my life that the only label I can put on what I have received is aggressive peace.

Aggressive. Aggressive peace.

I thought I knew a whole lot about the love of God. The reason I thought I knew a lot was that years ago, when God called me to a miracle and healing ministry, two or three years into that ministry He called me to old Mexico. I saw such devastating things that I canceled my meetings and went into the mountains for fasting and prayer.

When I came out of the mountains, He had told me, "If you want the best I have, Roberson, as a flesh-and-blood, air-breathing man on this side of glorification, all you need to do is walk in the fullness of My love."

Of course, I broke my fast and started to pursue everything I knew about love. I got everyone's tapes. I collected everything together. I studied John's writings, everything I could find on love, because God told me up in the mountains while I was fasting that love was a major key to the appropriation of the very best God has while a man is running around this side of glorification.

Before you start thinking wrong, sure, the love of God is my responsibility as an elder and an example in ministry. But before we are done this week, you ought to find out what the love of God can do for your business. Your business.

Him telling me that several years ago launched me into a seeking time where God had to bring me from where I was to an understanding of the limit love went for me in redemption. I first had to find out that nobody could love me like this Jesus. Nobody.

He is the culmination of love. He is the fullness of it. He is the embodiment of the entire love the Godhead possesses, manifested for humanity. That is my Jesus.

I could not love much because I had no revelation of how in love with me Jesus Christ is. It was not until He took me through the crucifixion, His descent into hell, and His resurrection to the right hand of the Father that I had any idea of the things He suffered when He was humanity.

I do not have much time to go into that phase of it, but I will say this: the pictures our artists have done of Jesus crucified are the best they can do according to carnal knowledge. But if you could capture the image He became when He was crucified, they could not hang it on the wall in your front room. When He became every damnable piece of broken humanity, you would not be able to have a light breakfast with that picture on your wall.

There was no pretty sight when every damnable piece of broken humanity that we were met up in the spirit and body of the Man Jesus, when He cried in a loud voice, "My God, You have forsaken Me," and God forsook Him, and He became everything we were.

It says His image was marred more than any man, His visible appearance more than the sons of men. His visage, meaning your pictures cannot do it justice. His visible appearance was marred more than any man, His form, the part of Him you look at, more than the sons of men.

You cannot paint an accurate description of when He descended to the lower bowels of the earth and suffered three damnable days and nights as the chastisement of my lack of peace was laid upon Him in the form of punishment.

I went from seeing Him hanging on the cross, as love went its limit for me, to His descent into a chamber so pitch black that He existed in a state of listlessness and innate consciousness, totally abandoned by God, by everything. There He lay in that state. I saw Him prostrate, flat on His back, lifting His hands and screaming in agony, "Help Me," crying by reason of His infirmity as worms crawled up and down His body, to all appearance crawling in and out of His eyes, ears, nose, and mouth.

When God got through with me, there was one thing Roberson understood: nobody could love me like this Jesus. Nobody.

Understanding that foundation of love, how head over heels in love with me this Jesus is, began to release me to love. But even then, it was only the first steps toward where He wanted to bring me.

He has given me such an experience that I can only speak firsthand. I keep making reference to where He brought me, and I am telling you, He is no respecter of persons. What He does for one, He will do for another.

I have news for you. You are more than a conqueror because you have been armed by the Prince of Peace with one of the most powerful weapons you could lay your hands on. It is the love of God, and it manifests itself in such aggressive peace that there is not anything that can stop you.

When He showed me how much my Father loves me, I thought, "Boy, that is good. He is fortifying me with the love of God. This is powerful." He said I need to walk in the fullness of this, and if I can walk in the fullness of it, I can attain to the very best God has as a flesh-and-blood, mortal, air-breathing man this side of glorification.

I started studying love. I thought the love of God was a sustaining force that would help me survive you. I said, "This love is all right. It seems to give me strength to survive my brother."

Some of you with that dumb look have never been done in.

I finally consolidated myself to this fact: as long as we are on planet earth, we are always going to be at the beginning, middle, or end of a test and trial. Sometimes you touch two short breaths in the space between trials, and then a new one begins. The only way you can escape that phenomenon is to change planets.

So the escape from testings and trials does not seem to be God changing them and eradicating them so poor little you can stand. "God, please, please change my circumstances."

He says, "I would, but you are the circumstance that needs change."

That is what I like about prayer. Prayer will change things, even if you are the thing that needs change.

So we say, "God, change the circumstances so I can bear it," and the thing He is trying to change is you.

I thought, "This love of God is pretty good. That is where you get the additional strength to keep from going under the third time." Somebody throws you a rope the third time, drags you to shore, and you say, "That is the love of God."

Sure, it is a sustaining force, but it is more than that. It is aggressive.

I found out the love of God had more to do with my relationship with God than it does with surviving you. I thought the love of God was some kind of attitude I was supposed to maintain toward you, even if I did not want to. "I do not want to, but I am a faith man. Oh, I love you." My inner man is killing you. My spirit arms have your neck.

I finally began to understand it had more to do with relationship.

As a matter of fact, I found a measuring stick. If you want to stick a measuring stick down in your spirit and pull it up to see how many quarts low you are on love, go to the book of John. He says perfect love casts out fear. He that has fear is not made perfect in love, because fear has torment.

If you take that dipstick and push it down into your spirit and pull it out, you can measure how much love you are walking in by measuring how free you are from torment and fear.

The whole time I thought it was to help me survive you so I would have a proper attitude toward you, even though I did not like it. But the love of God had everything to do with relationship.

It does not matter how you treat me. If I am walking in peace, I am only going to react one way to you, not because I am supposed to, but because of the relationship He has established in my heart with Him that has given me aggressive, overpowering, dominating peace.

Get out of my way, because I am eventually going to win.

I feel like I do not have long to teach. I feel that Miracle Worker coming. Let me tell you what began to spawn this.

By the time these next four services are over, you are going to be able to open your mouth and fasten your teeth on a big biteful of the love and peace of God. If you want it, you are going to find out how to walk into it on purpose, just because you want to.

"But Brother Roberson, you do not know how ugly I am."

What do you think the teaching is about? It is how to leave ugly behind.

"But you do not understand what I have been doing."

I do not care. The next three days, your problems are going to have big teeth marks in them. If you want, you can gnaw until you chew them off.

"But you do not understand."

No, you do not understand.

Do you know one reason Jesus said to get the beam out of your eye so you can see clearly to get the mote out of your brother's eye? If you are messed up in the same kinds of problems as the people you are trying to help, then you cannot see clearly to help them. But when you get out of those problems, things clear up. Your spiritual insight and wisdom start clearing up. The only reason you can step in and help them get the mote out of their eye is because you can see clearly now, because you are not involved in the same mess and have the beam out of your own eye.

Hallelujah.

When I was involved with that fighting stuff a little bit, I could not see to get you out of it. But now He has brought me out of it into peace. I am telling you, it is not worth staying in it.

He brought me further than I thought. He gave me wonderful messages on the love of God, but He brought me further. Do you know what He is doing to me now if I ask Him? And I do not ask Him very often. It seems like He has opened up a room, a peace room, where all I have to do is commune, and my heart pulls me in there, and by golly, He is there talking to me faster than you can shake a stick.

I never knew God talked so much. He said, "I have always been talking. You just have not been hearing."

He pulled me into that aggressive room of peace, and He is talking my ear off. He is starting to trust me. He used to only trust me with your physical ailments. That is not knowing much about you. I remember one time God gave me a vision of a woman's ear, the deteriorating bone in it, and the doctor had just given her the same diagnosis. He did something to her.

He has gone a little bit further, and I do not ask Him, but since He can trust me more with it now, He is beginning to open up things that block peace.

You are saying, "Brother Roberson, you mean to tell me that the character flaws and the things wrong with me, the things I have, I can walk out of them into peace?"

Yes.

There are a whole lot of you where the only one sitting in that chair is the facade man. He is the one you send to church, the one who prays over meals. He raises his hands and says, "Oh, how I love Jesus." Who knows the secrets the inner man is harboring? Hiding those ugly things. The Bible calls them strifes and hatreds. Then when you get into downright old-fashioned lusts, adultery, fornication, and people sneaking around living that stuff, they come to church with the old facade man: "Oh, how I love Jesus, because He first loved me." Nobody knows.

When you are caught up in a mess, a lot of times God cannot help you get motes out of people's eyes because you have beams in yours. You are quick to talk about people and sell people down the river. That stuff does not work.

But when He gets you to a place where He can trust you, He will use you to help people.

Do not look down. Do not let your eyes get shifty. It is a dead giveaway. Do not worry. He will not show a guy those things if he will not help you.

"Brother Roberson, you mean I can?"

Yes. We are going to break it down a step at a time, how you can receive the power. It is an enduring process, but you can receive it to walk out of every damnable thing Jesus said you are free from and into everything He said you could be.

Hallelujah.

Let us finish this testimony.

Nine years ago, when God pulled my roots up from Medford, Oregon, and moved our whole base of operation to Tulsa, Oklahoma, where preachers rise and fall and doctrine is set, I had spent seven years in evangelism up to that point, running around preaching on that first foundation of love He put me on.

Then He said, "I want you to resign all New Creation ministries." I had, I do not know, forty-three ministries under me, twenty-something churches, many of them I had trained. When we had camp meetings, they were fourteen or fifteen hundred people strong in a town of forty thousand. We had pioneered, built, and established.

To my surprise, when I got to Tulsa, He said, "Resign the whole thing. Turn the presidency over to another man."

I said, "God, what do You want me to do?"

He said, "You are to go as far as you can into Me for the sole purpose of pulling out the miraculous."

So I went to Tulsa. Our tapes started going out, and all of a sudden we became in demand as a camp-meeting speaker. I found myself on the same platform with men and women of God that I would have paid hundreds of dollars just to hold their sweaty old coats in the back room somewhere and hear the wisdom that came out of their mouths.

All of a sudden I found myself on the platform with them, preaching and teaching. I do not mind telling you, a fellow's head can get a little fat over that kind of stuff.

I lost all track of time and reality and hopped from one camp meeting to another. All the preachers of a certain sect had airplanes, so I went and got an airplane. How could I go have a camp meeting with all these guys and not be able to tie my big old fat twin down next to theirs?

You should have seen it when we got done with camp meeting, dropping us off at the airplanes. It was ridiculous. They filled the whole airport up. The child of God is in town. Several of them.

I flew from one meeting to the next, saving the world. It was fun.

But an old hunger I had in Medford took me over again. It caught up with me full bore when I was doing Mile-High Conference for Wally and Marilyn Hickey. I got to hurting so badly inside that I wanted to bawl.

I finally counseled with Marilyn and said, "Can you help me? I hurt so badly inside. I do not know how to quench it."

She said, "I can get you an appointment with Dr. Cho."

I said, "I will take it."

But on the way home in the airplane, God reminded me of the commission when I left Medford, Oregon. That commission was to go as far as I could into Him for the sole purpose of pulling out the miraculous.

Immediately I canceled my meetings. I had forgotten all about the love of God at this point. I went back into fasting and prayer times for God to line me up again.

Let me tell you what drove me in. For six years I returned to Mile-High Conference every year. This is the straw that broke the camel's back. Every year they had a person who signed in sign language, because there were seven or so totally deaf people on the front row.

You have to understand, every year Wally Hickey traded me off with the top healing evangelists in the world. Each year I had the privilege of standing on the platform with the foremost healing ministries in the world. And that row of deaf saints survived. They survived all of us and stayed deaf.

When I went into that first seeking time, I was hurt so badly. I said, "God, where are we? Where is aggressive faith? Where are the saints who would bombard heaven day and night until revival came? What has happened to us? Why have we died in indifference?"

The Lord told me that day, "The first step to revival is refusing. Refusing."

I refuse to accept things the way they are. I refuse.

It was not one seeking time. It was several. We do not have time now. But one of the last ones, not long ago, my hunger drove me in. I expected maybe Jesus to show up and say, "Son, if you will put your hand out, I will put a coal of fire in it. Then everybody you touch will have city-changing anointing on them."

But Jesus never came during the fast.

So I said, "Okay. I will settle for a couple of seven-foot, bronze-faced angels. They can come in and follow me around and manifest themselves to crowds once in a while, run up and lay their big hands on people's faces, tell me things, and we will do all right."

No angels came.

Near the end of it, the only thing I got was a still small voice. Do you know what it said?

"Break it."

"Break the fast?"

"Break it."

"But I do not feel any different."

"Break it."

So I did. After a few days, I noticed something had settled in, something I could not quite put my finger on. As time went by, the only way I could label it was as the most peaceful coexistence with Jesus. It became so dominant that I could finally only label it as aggressive peace.

After I had a full dose of it, the Holy Spirit came back and began to talk to me.

He said, "This is it."

I said, "Sir?"

He said, "This is what you have been looking for."

I said, "You mean in replacement of Jesus and two bronze-faced angels seven feet tall?"

He said, "Yes. This is the ingredient you have been looking for."

He said, "Son, I want to use you. I want to use everyone. I want every church I have established in the Holy Ghost to cause revival. I want them to tear their cities up, to change government. I want them to walk in so much power that it is incredible. When you do, you are going to attract powers and principalities that are intent on making you understand their stopping power."

So what does peace have to do with it? The same thing it had to do with Paul.

Paul said, "I sought God three times. Please, this thing has brought me to the edge, the bare naked edge of unbearability. I do not know if I can go another inch." God told him three times, "Paul, My grace is sufficient."

Makes you want to understand a little more about grace, does it not? If it is that sufficient, please, I will take five gallons of it.

He said, "My grace is sufficient."

I love the way Paul finally summed it up. After he found the sufficiency of grace, he said:

Most gladly therefore will I rather glory in my infirmities...

He said:

...for when I am weak, then am I strong.

What he was saying was this: anything supernatural that strips me of my dependency on the flesh simply places that dependency over onto the Spirit. What the devil designed as my defeat, designed to make me weak, made me strong because it transferred my strength over onto the Spirit. I can boldly declare, "When I am weak, stripped of my dependency on the flesh, I am strong."

So Paul cried out, "God, change my circumstances."

God said, "Okay, Paul, you got it, even though you are the circumstance that still needs change."

What does peace have to do with it? It has grace to do with it.

It does not matter what the devil does. He can dig a hole a mile deep and dump everything in it that means anything to you, and he still cannot manage your life because you are not susceptible to his pressure.

If he can manage you with cares and pressure this week, he already has next week planned out for you. You are not your own. He has to survive us this week, because we are going to put you into next week, not him.

Why do you think Peter said:

Humble yourselves therefore under the mighty hand of God, that he may exalt you in due time:

Casting all your care upon him; for he careth for you.

Humble yourself, become extremely teachable under the mighty hand of God so He can exalt you in due time, casting the whole of your care over onto Him, for He cares for you. He wants to exalt you in due time.

What qualifies Him to do this? If you cast all your cares over on Him, then it releases Him to lavish His care upon you.

Then:

Be sober, be vigilant; because your adversary the devil, as a roaring lion, walketh about, seeking whom he may devour:

Whom resist stedfast in the faith...

Those two verses go together. He said, "Cast your care." Why? Because your adversary is on the loose, and he uses your care as a primary catalyst to devour you. That is why He said to get it over onto Him so He can lavish His care on you. Then you can resist the devil steadfast in the faith.

Since aggressive peace, I have found that the strongest resistance I can lay on the devil is not to take the care.

I like Lester Sumrall, the war horse. He was on the field fifty years, closer to sixty, now seventy-seven. He spanned sixty years of preaching the gospel. He walked through Tibet on foot when he was eighteen years old, preaching off the back of a mule. He knew Smith Wigglesworth, who prayed with him in the mornings at the beginning of his young ministry. Incredible.

This is what Lester thinks about the devil. One day, somewhere in a land far away, Lester Sumrall's bed in the motel room started walking across the room.

Old Lester said, "Drop it!"

The bed went clunk, and the devil, of course, was fleeing by that time. I understand Lester was in the other room. If the devil had known it was him, he would have left his bed alone. Pretty bold devil to go in the room with Lester.

So Lester screamed out, "Come back! Come back, devil!"

The devil had to come back. Most people say, "The devil says he does not want to come out." But with Lester, the devil says, "Please, please."

Lester said, "Come back!" The devil came back. Lester said, "Put the bed back!"

What are we going to do? We are going to take a step. We are going to take a big bite out of aggressive peace this week. We are going to chomp down heavy. I do not care what kind of turmoil you are in. I am telling you, you can walk out of it. Walk out of it on purpose, just because you want to.